- Should not be applied on very young and very old patients.
- Should not be applied on clients with high temperature.

Contraindications of cold applications

- Cold should not be applied on clients who are in the stage of shock and collapse
- Cold should not be applied when there is edema.
- Cold should not be applied on clients with circulatory disorders.
- Cold should not be applied on patients with decreased sensation
- Patients with shivering and very low temperature,
- Cold should not be applied when there is infected wound.

Complications of hot and cold applications

Hot application	Cold Application
Pain	Pain
Burns	Blisters and skin breakdown
Maceration	Maceration
Redness of the skin	Gray or bluish discoloration
Edema	Thrombus formation
Pallor(secondary effects)	Redness(secondary effects)
Hyperthermia	Hypothermia

General instructions

- Asses the condition of the clients before and after the hot and cold applications.
- Maintain the correct temperature for the entire duration of the application
- Expose the client only to the safe temperature.
- Do not allow the clients to adjust the temperature control of appliance such as short wave diathermy, electric heating pads etc.
- Never ignore the complaints of clients however small they appear to be.
- Always make sure that the client is in position to remove the application
- The client must have a calling signal within reach
- Never leave a client alone even for a short period that cannot move from the appliances.
- A thin layer of petroleum jelly or oil should be applied to the skin prior the application of moist heat application.
- Do not use electrical appliances near to open oxygen. A small spark may cause explosion.
- Do not handle electrical appliances with the wet hands.

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